

Americas Technology: Hardware: AI Project Pulse: May 2026

AI Project Pulse

Monthly updates in the AI project space across neoclouds, sovereigns, and enterprise

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We summarize recent announcements and developments in the AI project space across neoclouds, sovereigns, and enterprise made in May 2026. This represents select project announcements and is not indicative of the total AI infrastructure opportunity.

Key highlights in May 2026 include:

- **Neoclouds expanding software & orchestration layers:** Recent neocloud M&A activity (IREN/Mirantis, Nebius/Eigen AI) has been focused on adding vertically integrating orchestration and optimization layers to into GPU compute capacity. This evolution signals a strategic pivot from providing compute capacity (primarily for model building and research labs) to providing the seamless, production-ready infrastructure and managed inference services (essential for scaling enterprise AI workloads).
- **Enterprises demand for on-premise and hybrid AI deployments is broadening.** At Dell Technologies World on 5/19, DELL highlighted several on-premise & hybrid infrastructure deployments across industries including manufacturing (Samsung, Mazda), financial services (Hudson River Trading), and healthcare (Eli Lilly's LillyPod supercomputer).

Neoclouds & data center operators

Headlines presented in reverse chronological order.

IREN enters into \$1.6 bn purchase agreement with DELL (5/26/26): IREN has entered into purchase agreements for \$1.6 bn in air-cooled, Blackwell-based systems, as part of its previously announced 5-year AI cloud contract with NVIDIA.

- **Key Details:** Assuming 14kW per DGX B200 rack, we estimate IREN is acquiring ~26K B200 GPUs (45MW/14kW per DGX B200 rack*8 GPUS per rack) assuming ~\$500k per DGX B200 rack, which is consistent with the disclosed \$1.6 bn

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purchase price.

Blackstone/Google Announce JV for TPU Cloud (5/18/26): Blackstone and Google have entered into a joint venture to create a new U.S.-based company dedicated to providing compute-as-a-service powered by Google Cloud's Tensor Processing Units (TPUs).

- **Key Details:** 500 MW of initial capacity; first capacity expected to come online in 2027 with plans to scale significantly over time; Google will supply hardware, including TPUs, as well as software and service
- **Size:** Initial \$5 billion equity commitment from Blackstone.

Akamai signs \$1.8bn cloud contract with Anthropic (5/8/26): Akamai Technologies has secured a landmark \$1.8 billion, seven-year agreement with Anthropic to provide cloud infrastructure services. Akamai will support Anthropic's need for low-latency AI model deployment across global markets, complementing Anthropic's existing centralized training capacity.

- **Key Details:** Cloud Infrastructure Services, edge network with over 4,200 points of presence, Akamai Cloud Inference, and Akamai Inference Cloud utilizing NVIDIA RTX PRO 6000 Blackwell servers and BlueField-3 data processing units
- **Key Partners:** Akamai Technologies and Anthropic
- **Size:** \$1.8 billion commitment over seven years
- **Location:** Global (over 130 countries)

NVIDIA and IREN Announce Strategic Partnership (5/7/26): NVIDIA and IREN have entered into a strategic partnership, targeting the deployment of up to 5 gigawatts of NVIDIA DSX-aligned capacity. The collaboration combines NVIDIA's DSX AI factory architecture with IREN's expertise in power, land, and data center operations to expand access for AI-native and enterprise customers. As part of the agreement, NVIDIA received a five-year right to purchase up to 30 million shares of IREN ordinary stock at \$70 per share, representing a potential investment of up to \$2.1 billion.

- **Key Details:** NVIDIA DSX-aligned AI infrastructure, DSX AI factories, integration of compute, networking, software, and power, and a five-year stock purchase agreement for NVIDIA.
- **Size:** Up to 5 gigawatts of infrastructure deployment and a potential \$2.1 billion investment right.
- **Previously Announced Partners:** IREN has previously announced DELL as a key server vendor in its data center build outs.

GPU-as-a-Service Cloud Vultr Announces Collaboration with SUSE and SMCI (5/6/26): Vultr has partnered with SUSE (open-source software company that develops and sells enterprise-grade Linux operating systems, cloud computing platforms, and container management solutions) and Supermicro (AI hardware vendor) to debut a unified Cloud-to-Edge architectural framework for global AI scaling. This strategic initiative integrates high-performance hardware, localized cloud infrastructure, and unified Kubernetes management to solve the complexities of operating AI workloads

across distributed environment.

- **Key Details:** Three layers of cloud: (1) Cloud and Near-Edge layer leveraging Vultr's 33 global regions and NVIDIA GPUs; (2) a Metro Edge layer utilizing Supermicro's CPU and GPU-capable edge servers validated with SUSE Linux; and (3) a Control Layer using SUSE Edge for GitOps-driven management of thousands of sites.

IREN acquires Mirantis (5/5/26): IREN has signed a definitive agreement to acquire Mirantis (provider of cloud infrastructure, Kubernetes-based orchestration and enterprise support services) for approximately \$625 million in ordinary shares to enhance its AI Cloud delivery capabilities across its renewable-powered data center portfolio in the U.S. and Canada.

- **Key Details:** The proposed acquisition supports: (1) faster deployment and operation of workloads on IREN's existing GPU infrastructure; (2) improves operational visibility (monitoring, performance, mgmt); (2) Technical support, service delivery; and (4) expanded customer base to emerging enterprise AI workloads.

Nebius agrees to acquire Eigen AI (5/1/26): Nebius has entered into an agreement to acquire Eigen AI, a prominent inference and model optimization company, for ~\$643 million. This strategic acquisition is designed to enhance the Nebius Token Factory by integrating Eigen AI's industry-leading optimization stack with Nebius's global compute capacity and AI cloud platform. The collaboration aims to provide enterprise-grade autoscaling endpoints and fine-tuning pipelines that deliver superior model performance and unit economics for production AI workloads.

- **Key Details:** Integration of inference and post-training optimization layers into Nebius Token Factory; support for major open-source models including Llama, Qwen, Gemma, and DeepSeek; and the utilization of advanced techniques such as Sparse Attention (SpAtten) and Activation-aware Weight Quantization (AWQ).
- **Location:** Amsterdam (Nebius HQ) and the San Francisco Bay Area (new engineering and research presence).

Sovereign & Enterprise

Headlines presented in reverse chronological order.

Spectra Supercomputer at Sandia National Laboratories Achieves Full System

Acceptance (5/18/26): Sandia National Laboratories has achieved full system acceptance for Spectra, its newest Vanguard program supercomputer featuring 128 NextSilicon Maverick-2 dual-die accelerators across 64 compute nodes, to evaluate advanced runtime-reconfigurable architectures for national security applications

- **Key Details:** 64 compute nodes, 128 Maverick-2 dual-die accelerators, and runtime-reconfigurable dataflow architecture
- **Key Partners:** Sandia National Laboratories, NextSilicon, Penguin Solutions, and the National Nuclear Security Administration (NNSA)

- **Location:** Sandia National Laboratories

Australian neocloud Sharon AI signs \$950m cloud deal (5/18/26): Australian neocloud Sharon AI has secured a \$950 million agreement to deploy cloud computing infrastructure across multiple NextDC data centers in Australia for a global technology company over a five-year period.

- **Key Details:** Vast Data's AI Operating System for unified storage, database, compute, and real-time processing; 1,000 NVIDIA B200 GPU supercluster; CSCO Secure AI Factory (previously announced)
- **Location:** Australia (including Sydney, Melbourne, Brisbane, Perth, Port Hedland, Canberra, Adelaide, Darwin, Sunshine Coast, and Newman)
- **Timing:** Revenue generation expected to begin by the end of Q3 2026, with further deployments in Q4 2026

Dell highlights several infrastructure enterprise customers across different industries (5/19/26): At Dell Technologies World 2026 in Las Vegas, DELL made several customer announcements including:

- **Mistral AI** uses Dell AI Factory with Nvidia to support its AI research environment (Dell PowerRack with Dell PowerEdge XE9712 with GB200s; Dell professional services).
- **Samsung Electronics** uses Dell solutions for semi-conductor design, manufacturing, and automation
- **Eli Lilly** uses Dell hardware, architecture consulting, and integration support for its LillyPod supercomputer (*1,016 Blackwell Ultra GPU supercomputer announced in February 2026*). Beyond research, Dell provide on-premise compute, storage, and backups across Lilly's manufacturing footprint (digital twins, simulation).
- **Hudson River Trading** is using Dell AI factory for its purpose-built AI research data center in Norway (Dell IRSS with Dell PowerEdge XE9685L servers with AMD processors, HGX B200 systems, and Spectrum-X Ethernet networking), as well as standardizing its data foundation on Dell PowerScale with PowerEdge R-series servers.
- **Mazda** plans to use Dell PowerScale, part of the Dell AI Data Platform, to unify its model-based development and CAD storage environments into a scalable infrastructure designed to evolve into a data lake supporting AI and generative AI workloads.

Dell announces new hardware and platform solutions to support agentic AI workloads (5/18/26): At Dell Technologies World 2026 in Las Vegas, DELL made several product announcements including:

- **(1) Introduce PowerRack:** integrated rack-scale solutions (compute, networking, and storage configurations) that are pre-built and validated, with the power and cooling already integrated. Dell PowerRack for compute is available now, while PowerRack for networking will be available in September 2026, and for storage in 2H 2026

- **(2) Other hardware product launches:** Dell Pro Precision 7 R1 (mountable rack workstation), Dell PowerCool cooling distribution unit (CDU) C7000, Powerstore Elite
- **(3) Support for agentic AI workloads:** Dell now offers support for Nvidia's OpenShell runtime platform, which allows organizations to build, deploy, and govern agents in a secure sandboxed environment. Dell also announced Dell Deskside Agentic AI, to allow enterprise to more securely build and run autonomous agents locally.
- **(4) Expanded Dell AI Data Platform capabilities:** Enhancements to its orchestration and search capabilities, updates to its SQL analytics platform so it can support Nvidia Blackwell GPUs and the forthcoming Vera CPU, and integrating Dell's storage and search engines with Nvidia Omniverse.
- **(5) New AI Ecosystem program:** Will provide AI software companies with a structured path to validate solutions on Dell AI Factory infrastructure. Initial ecosystem partners include Google, Hugging Face, OpenAI, Palantir, Reflection, ServiceNow, and SpaceXAI.

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